



The Valdosta Daily Times

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Daybreak

Valdosta should see partly cloudy skies with a 40 percent chance of thunderstorms. The high should be in the lower 90s.

Complete weather details on page 2-A.

Locally

VPD Gets Classroom

The Valdosta School Board is giving a used, portable classroom to the Valdosta Police Department for a shelter at its shooting range.

Vickie Burt, director of personnel and instruction for the city school system, said the portable classroom at Valdosta High has not been used for classes since 1985. Until now, it has been used for storage, she said.

—Laura Johns

BOE To Meet

The Valdosta School Board has announced its meeting dates for the next fiscal year.

All meetings are held on Mondays at 7:30 p.m. in the superintendent's office at 120 Williams St.

Meeting dates for the remainder of 1990 are July 9, Aug. 20, Sept. 17, Oct. 15, Nov. 19 and Dec. 17.

—Laura Johns

Briefly

'Robin Hud'

ALTIMORE — "Robin Hud," the former real estate agent who claimed she stole about \$6 million from HUD to help the poor, was sentenced Friday to the maximum prison term of nearly four years.

U.S. District Judge Herbert Murray issued the 46-month sentence at the request of the agent, Marilyn Harrell, who federal officials said stole more from the government than any individual.

"I will ask you for the maximum term because I deserve it," Harrell told the judge. "I have never said what I did was right. In fact, if a person steals cents they should be done with whatever the court sees fit."

Murray also sentenced Harrell to three years' probation and 624 hours of community service and ordered her to pay \$600,000 in restitution. She was also ordered to serve a concurrent one-year sentence on the tax charge.

Prosecutors asked Murray to refigure the federal sentencing guideline formula used to determine her sentence, moving the limits from 30 to 37 months for 27 to 30 years, because of mitigating factors.

—The Associated Press

Lottery

MIAMI — Here are the winning numbers selected Friday in the Florida Lottery.

Cash 5
6-83
Fantasy 5
12-35-33-34

Today's Tips

The Knights of Columbus has its annual Red, White and Blue Dinner-Dance at 7 p.m. at 306 St. Augustine Road, with proceeds earmarked for local charities.

Index

Classified	7-10B
Obituaries	4B
Editorials	4A
Business	4A
Obituaries	2A
Religion	7A
Sports	1-3B
Weather	5-8

Teacher's Death Still Mystery

By DEAN POLING
Times Staff Writer

A Lowndes County teacher found shot to death earlier this week was buried Friday afternoon as sheriff's officials continued their investigation into mysterious circumstances surrounding her death.

Beverly K. Schappagh, 48, of Valdosta was found dead in a vehicle, parked in the playground beside her workplace, Pine Grove Primary School, early Monday morning.

She died from internal bleeding caused by a single gunshot wound to the left breast area. A gun belonging to Ms. Schappagh was found beside her in the car's passenger seat, but whether it was the gun used in her death has not yet been determined if this was the gun used in her death.

Lowndes County Sheriff's Department officials are still attempting to determine the motive behind Ms. Schappagh's death.

Officials know she was shot sometime between 5 p.m. Sunday and early Monday morning.

They believe Ms. Schappagh went to Pine Grove Primary to finish some school work that afternoon.

In addition to the fatal gunshot wound, there were several minor injuries on her body. According to reports from the Georgia State Crime Lab in Atlanta, she had a black eye, a bruise on one of her shoulders and both knees were scraped.

Lowndes County Sheriff G. Robert Carter said Friday the department's detective bureau is investigating every angle of the shooting but would not comment on the case's status.

Anyone in the vicinity of Pine Grove Primary on Benias Road from Sunday afternoon to Monday morning with any information regarding this case call 333-5138.

Colleagues and friends described Ms. Schappagh as a dedicated teacher who worked in the Lowndes County school system since 1973. She was a teacher at Habersham Elementary from 1979-1989 and worked at Pine Grove Primary for the past year.



Rain Lily

A day lily soaks up rain after a small shower. The day lily is in the garden at The Crescent in Valdosta and enjoyed the cooler temperatures and brief rain showers that hit the city Friday afternoon — Times Photo by Paul Leary.

Moody Getting NEXRAD System

By MARIO CHRISTALDI
Times Staff Writer

WASHINGTON — Moody Air Force Base is scheduled to get a sophisticated \$2 million storm-tracking radar system as part of a nationwide overhaul of the National Weather Service's radar network.

The radar, scheduled for delivery to Moody in October 1993, is touted for its ability to detect dangerous weather systems as they are developing.

Based on the intensity we can issue a warning right away, and you

get the extra 20 or 30 minutes to take cover or organize emergency forces," said Don Sarreals, a Weather Service meteorologist involved in coordinating the project. "It allows you to gear up for anything — before it's too late," he said. There are plans to install 175 of the NEXRAD — Next Generation Weather Radars — at sites in the United States and worldwide during the next five years.

A visitor to the NEXRAD site at Moody would see a small fenced compound and steel tower, topped by a 35-foot diameter ball housing a

35-foot radar antenna.

The installations are to be part of an estimated \$20 billion Weather Service modernization program aimed at replacing outmoded technology with a high-tech arsenal of radars, computers and satellites. Along with early warning, the equipment is expected to cut down on false alarms.

Rep. James Scheuer, D-N.Y., who chairs a House panel studying the Weather Service's capabilities, has called the current weather forecasting system "a national shame" that is "voicing in the Paleolithic age."

A Rising Storm Locally

By DEAN POLING
Times Staff Writer

AIDS cases in South Georgia have risen slightly this year, say most local health officials. While two northern Florida hospitals report their number of AIDS-related cases are about the same as last year, Corretta Roberts, AIDS health educator at the Lowndes County Health Department, said Friday about 100 cases were reported within the past year in two units of Georgia's Health District 9 — which is up slightly from a year ago, she said.

She also noted more heterosexuals are testing positive for AIDS, while the homosexual rate of cases has stabilized regionally.

County-by-county figures of reported AIDS cases were not available. District 8 Unit 1 includes Lowndes, Brooks, Berrien, Cook, Lanier, Echols, Tift, Turner, Ben Hill and Irwin counties. District 2, headquartered in Albany, handles a six- to seven-county area, she said.

Though no regional estimates of AIDS-related deaths were available at the health department, two local hospitals reported at least four in the past year.

Dr. Russell Acree of the Memorial Hospital of Adel reported two AIDS-related deaths. He said he was dealing with eight to 10 AIDS patients in the local area.

Acree said everyone should be tested for the disease. "It's very difficult to give an estimate of how many people in the region may have the AIDS virus because so many people have been tested," he said.

Brooks County Hospital reported two AIDS cases with two deaths in 1989, said Joann Moore, director of medical records and utilization services.

Though Brooks County Hospital handles AIDS cases on a "watch bed system" with other area medical facilities, Ms. Moore said the hospital had no AIDS patients previous to last year.

AIDS In The Area

- Brooks County Hospital reported three AIDS cases this year with two deaths.
- Madison County (Fla.) Memorial Hospital reported handling 20 cases but had no AIDS-related deaths in the past year.
- Hamilton County (Fla.) Memorial Hospital reported handling 10 cases so far this year.

Clinch Memorial Hospital reported no deaths and only three to four AIDS cases in the past few years, said Loren Dickerson, nursing director.

Berrien County Hospital reported no deaths as well as no cases within the past year. Cindy Odum, a hospital representative, said. The hospital had only one AIDS case last year, she said.

Lanier County's Louis Smith Memorial Hospital reported no deaths and "less than three cases" last year, said director of medical records, said.

South Georgia Medical Center in Valdosta had no available records for release Friday afternoon.

But, whereas regional hospitals in Florida reported relatively low number of AIDS cases, Florida's Hamilton and Madison counties had a much higher rate of reported AIDS cases.

Mike Parley, administrator of Madison County Memorial Hospital, said his institution dealt with no AIDS-related deaths but reported 20 cases the past year. A number consistent with last year's reported cases.

Hamilton County Memorial Hospital, Administrator Amelia Tuten said they've seen about 10 AIDS cases which is about the same as last year.

LHS Student Gets Intensive Probation

By KELLI BOWMAN
Times Staff Writer

A Lowndes High School student, accused of raping another student, was given a maximum sentence Friday of 12 months intensive probation after pleading guilty to fornication.

Michael G. Robinson, 18, indicted on two counts of rape in February, pleaded guilty to one count of the misdemeanor on May 22.

A Lowndes student accused of raping another Lowndes student twice on school grounds during 1989.

Robinson, 18, was charged with the sexual offense after a victim, who attended special education classes, reported being raped in May and in April. She did not identify Robinson as her attacker until after the

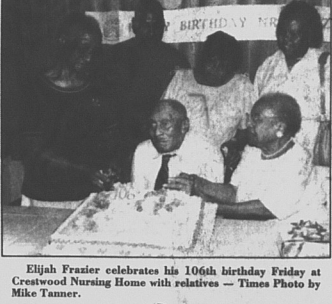
second incident.

The victim was taken to South Georgia Medical Center afterward, and physical examinations indicated she was forced to have sex, prosecutor Catherine Helms said.

Defense lawyer Jim Jarvis said Robinson was the May incident, but that Robinson and the victim had consorted to sex at school in September. Jarvis said Friday he felt the sentence was reasonable.

"It comes from a good family, and is a good boy," the lawyer said.

As a condition of probation, Robinson will not be allowed to return to school as long as the victim attends classes there. Judge H. Arthur Starnes said he would not allow him to have any contact with the girl.



Elijah Frazier celebrates his 106th birthday Friday at Crestwood Nursing Home with relatives — Times Photo by Mike Tanner.

Frazier: Looking For Another 100

By LAURA JOHNS
Times Staff Writer

"In 1894, I was 100 years old," said Valdosta's Elijah Frazier. "I reckon I'll make it another hundred."

Frazier, a resident of Crestwood Nursing Home, celebrated his 106th birthday Friday. Other residents of the nursing home and some of his relatives sang "Happy Birthday" to the first and heaviest man in the county.

Frazier's three nieces, Georgia Myrtle and Vera, and his daughter Dora and Dora King of Plant City, Fla., and his great nephew John Fleming said beside him at the party.

"It's not every day that someone turns 106," said Gwyn Hooker, Frazier's daughter-in-law.

"When I went into his room this morning, he was 6 years old and I was 100," she said.

The oldest man in town, Jackson Pollock, 123, lives in Milledgeville, but Valdosta's 106-year-old could be the oldest living man in the South.

Frazier has trouble hearing, but he is very alert and talkative. In fact, he often asks residence workers why he can't go home since nothing is wrong with him, Mrs. Hooker said.

"If he could see and hear better, he'd be out here," said Frazier said. "I'm feeling plumb fine."

The DuPont native said Valdosta is his home, although he lived much of his life in Florida working in the timber business. He also ran barber shops in Tampa and Sarasota, Fla., and in Valdosta for many years.

After he retired, he worked as a gardener. Frazier said he was one man's gardener for 31 years.

"I haven't done a nickel's worth of

work since 1924," when he entered Crestwood, Frazier said. They won't let me work in here, and that'll make poor money."

But Frazier said he still has many years of life left in him and will enjoy each one. His favorite activity in the nursing home is attending church services.

The only time he doesn't attend the nursing home church services is when he's at the church he once attended being him communion on the first and second of each month, Mrs. Hooker said.

Frazier said he is proud to be 106 and considers it quite an accomplishment.

"There's more old women than there are old men because in the old world War I and WW II killed the men," he said. "I really doubt I'll make it another hundred because that's just too far away."

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